

Heirs' Property Indicators for Colonial Heights

Richmond MSA heirs' property study. Locality fact sheet.



Heirs' property can arise when real estate passes to family members after an owner dies without a clear transfer of title. When an estate is never formally settled, ownership can splinter across descendants while the deed remains unchanged. Without a clear title, families may struggle to sell or refinance the home, borrow against it for repairs, obtain disaster-recovery assistance, or pass it on to others.

This sheet summarizes the heirs' property indicators found across Colonial Heights's parcels, read from public records. The result is a regional screen identifying parcels with an elevated risk of being an heirs' property, not a legal determination of title. The numbers below show how many parcels were flagged, how they compare to the rest of the local parcel stock, and where in Colonial Heights they cluster.

FLAGGED PARCELS	SHARE OF PARCEL STOCK	CONFIDENCE TIERS	CLUSTER TRACTS
317	4.12%	85 / 232	2 hot / 0 cold
of 7,695 parcels	study area 2.12%	high confidence / likely	of 5 census tracts

Flagged Parcels vs. All Parcel Stock

Colonial Heights

	FLAGGED	ALL STOCK
Median assessed value	\$169,950	\$173,500
Median build year	1963	1965
USPS vacancy, known status	23.17%	3.49%

Study Area for Comparison

Richmond MSA study area, 8,091 flagged of 381,852 parcels

	FLAGGED	ALL STOCK
Median assessed value	\$245,700	\$329,000
Median build year	1965	1981
USPS vacancy, known status	9.55%	1.03%

Ownership Signals

Share of flagged parcels carrying each signal

Deceased owner of record		81.1%
Long tenure		89.6%
Absentee owner		29.0%
Out-of-state owner		5.4%

Property Type Mix

Share of flagged parcels by type

Occupied family home		72.9%
Multi-owner absentee home		0.3%
Empty lot		3.5%
Vacant house		23.3%

Flag counts reflect indicator-based screening of parcel records, not legal determinations of title. Totals are best read as a floor, not a ceiling.

Vacancy is the share of parcels with a known USPS vacancy status. Parcels with no status on record are excluded from the denominator.

Property types are groupings of statistically similar parcels. No single trait defines membership.

Hot- and cold-cluster tracts have flagged-parcel rates statistically above or below the regional pattern. Tracts with fewer than 5 heirs-flagged parcels or fewer than 100 total parcels are not assigned a rate class. 0 of 5 tracts here are below that threshold.

High confidence indicates stronger, converging heirs' property evidence. Likely indicates meaningful but less conclusive evidence. Both are classifications, not legal determinations of heirs' property status.